

Unit: To Be or Not to Be

詳細內容雙語對照 / Detailed Bilingual Content

Unit Expressions / 單元核心表達

We will look at five expressions and their meanings in this unit. They are: 1. To be or not to be, that is the question. 2. Talk to the hand 3. Déjà vu 4. Air quotation 5. Too much information.

在本單元中，我們將探討五個常用表達及其含義：1. 生存還是毀滅，這是個問題。2. 跟我的手說吧（不想聽你說）。3. 既視感（似曾相識）。4. 空中引號（表示諷刺或否定）。5. 訊息量太大（TMI）。

Expression 1: To Be or Not to Be, That is the Question / 表達一：生存還是毀滅，這是個問題。

Lead-in Questions / 導入問題

1. Hamlet says 'To be or not to be' because he is questioning the value of life and asking himself whether it's worthwhile hanging in there.

1. 哈姆雷特說「生存還是毀滅」，因為他正在質疑生命的價值，並問自己是否值得堅持下去。

2. To be, or not to be, that is the question: Whether 'tis nobler in the mind to suffer The slings and arrows of outrageous fortune, Or to take arms against a sea of troubles And by opposing end them.

2. 生存還是毀滅，這是個問題：是否在心靈中忍受狂暴命運的飛石和暗箭更顯高貴，還是挺身反抗無邊的苦難，並通過奮鬥將其掃除。

Meaning / 含意

To be or not to be, that is the question: It is used to express one's indecision or hesitation about doing something. It is derived from the famous line in Act 3, Scene 1 of William Shakespeare's Hamlet, "To be, or not to be, that is the question." (Farlex Dictionary of Idioms)

「生存還是毀滅，這是個問題」：它用來表達一個人對做某事時的猶豫不決或遲疑。它源自威廉·莎士比亞的《哈姆雷特》第三幕第一場中的著名台詞：「生存還是毀滅，這是個問題。」（法雷克斯俚語詞典）

Origin & Analysis / 起源與分析

It originates from Hamlet, a tragedy written by William Shakespeare, about 1599–1601. As the play opens, Hamlet is mourning his father, who has been killed, and lamenting the behavior of his mother, Gertrude, who married his uncle Claudius within a month of his father's death. The ghost of his father appears to Hamlet, informs him that he was poisoned by Claudius, and commands Hamlet to avenge his death.

它源於威廉·莎士比亞大約在 1599 至 1601 年間創作的悲劇《哈姆雷特》。戲劇開場時，哈姆雷特正在哀悼被殺害的父親，並為他母親葛楚德在父親去世不到一個月內就嫁給他的叔叔克勞迪斯的行為感到哀傷。他父親的鬼魂向哈姆雷特顯現，告知他自己是被克勞迪斯毒死的，並命令哈姆雷特為他的死報仇。

The soliloquy is essentially all about life and death: "To be or not to be" means "To live or not to live" (or "To live or to die"). Hamlet discusses how painful and miserable human life is, and how death (specifically suicide) would be preferable, would it not be for the fearful uncertainty of what comes after death.

這段獨白本質上完全是關於生命與死亡的：「生存還是毀滅」意為「活著還是不活」（或「生存還是死亡」）。哈姆雷特討論了人類的生活是多麼痛苦和悲慘，如果不是因為對死後世界可怕的不確定性，死亡（特別是自殺）將是更可取的。

Extended Content: Expressions 2 to 5 / 延伸內容：表達二至五

Expression 2: Talk to the hand / 表達二：跟我的手說吧

Talk to the hand: It is informal and used in spoken English. It is used to tell someone rudely that you do not want to listen to anything they are going to say. (Longman Dictionary of Contemporary English) You can use the phrase before the person starts talking to you or use it during the conversation to cut them off. Typically, people that use “talk to the hand” will put their hand in front of the other person’s face that’s talking to them. It can have an ominous or a friendly tone, depending on the situation. Many people use the phrase to poke fun at someone or stop them from asking for money.

跟我的手說吧 (Talk to the

hand)：這是一種口語和非正式的表達。它用於粗魯地告訴某人你不想聽他們要說的任何話。(《朗文當代英語辭典》) 你可以在對方開始跟你說話之前使用這個片語，或者在對話中使用它來打斷對方。通常，使用這個表達的人會把手放在對他們說話的人的臉前。根據具體情況，它可以帶有威脅性或友好的語調。許多人用這個片語來取笑某人，或阻止他們要錢。

Examples: Jack: What do you mean you can’t help me out? Ana: I’ve heard enough, Jack, talk to the hand.

範例：傑克：你說你不能幫我忙是什麼意思？安娜：我聽夠了，傑克，跟我的手說吧。

Expression 3: Déjà vu / 表達三：既視感 (似曾相識)

Déjà vu: It is used to describe the feeling that what is happening now has happened before in exactly the same way. (Longman Dictionary of Contemporary English) “Déjà vu” is literally translated from French to mean “already seen.” It is a sense of having already seen something—coupled with knowing you haven’t actually seen it. When it is used in a sentence, it could be used to express a feeling that one has seen or heard something before.

既視感 (Déjà

vu)：它用於描述一種感覺，即現在正在發生的事情以前曾以完全相同的方式發生過。(《朗文當代英語辭典》)「Déjà vu」字面意思從法語翻譯為「已經看見過」。這是一種已經見過某事的感覺，同時又清楚地知道自己實際上並沒有見過它。當在句子中使用時，它可以表示一個人以前曾看過或聽過某事的感覺。

In 2006, the movie “Déjà vu”, an American science fiction action film starring Denzel Washington, involves an agent who travels back in time in an attempt to prevent a domestic terrorist attack and to save a woman with whom he falls in love. Olivia Rodrigo’s song “Déjà vu” became extremely popular while released in 2021, and the tune depicts Rodrigo as an ex-girlfriend who realizes that her former lover’s new girlfriend is just like her.

在2006年的電影《既視感》(Déjà vu)中，由丹佐·華盛頓主演的一部美國科幻動作片，講述了一名特工回到過去，試圖阻止一起國內恐怖襲擊並拯救他愛上的女人的故事。奧莉維亞·羅德里戈在2021年發行的歌曲《Déjà vu》變得非常受歡迎，曲調描述了羅德里戈作為一個前女友，意識到前任的新女友和她一模一樣。

Examples: When I met her, I had a strange feeling of déjà vu. I entered the room and immediately felt a sense of déjà vu.

範例：當我遇見她時，我有一種奇怪的既視感。我進入房間，立刻感到一種既視感。

Expression 4: Air quotation / 表達四：空中引號

Air quotation: It is a movement that someone makes in the air with their fingers to show that what they are saying should be in quotation marks, and that it should not be taken as their real opinion or their usual way of speaking. (Longman Dictionary of Contemporary English) This sign means that you are quoting someone's statements. However, it is often used altogether with tone to convey your sarcasm and satire about what is being quoted or highlight a word or a phrase when we speak and show disagreement of word choice.

空中引號 (Air quotation)：這是一個人用手指在空中做出的動作，表示他們所說的話應該加上引號，不應被視為他們的真實觀點或他們平常的說話方式。(《朗文當代英語辭典》) 這個手勢意味著你正在引用某人的陳述。然而，它通常與語氣一起使用，以表達你對所引用內容的諷刺和挖苦，或者在我們說話時突出一個單字或片語，並表示對字詞選擇的不同意。

Examples: Dr. Steve's misinformed statements on the dangers of vaccination seem to suggest that we should use air quotes when calling him 'doctor'. The commercial said it was so "reasonable" and "affordable", but really it's just a rip-off.

範例：史蒂夫博士關於接種疫苗危險的錯誤言論似乎表明，我們在稱他為『醫生』時應該使用空中引號。廣告上說它是如此的「合理」和「負擔得起」，但實際上它只是一個騙局。

Expression 5: Too much information / 表達五：訊息量太大 / 說得太多了

Too much information: It is informal and used in spoken English. It is used when someone has just told you details that you think are embarrassing or unpleasant, and you do not want to hear any more. (Longman Dictionary of Contemporary English) It is an expression indicating that someone has revealed information that is too personal and made the listener or reader uncomfortable. It could be written as "TMI".

訊息量太大 (Too much information / TMI)：這是口語和非正式的表達。它用於當某人剛剛告訴你你認為尷尬或不愉快的細節，且你不想再聽下去時。(《朗文當代英語辭典》)

這是一種表示某人透露了過於私人且讓聽眾或讀者感到不舒服的信息的表達。它可以寫成「TMI」。

Examples: Jack: I've been to the toilet twice already. Ana: Too much information!

範例：傑克：我已經去過兩次廁所了。安娜：訊息量太大！